

sold off to any industry. In its new *avatar*, it could even become a doctor's assistant, helping monitor a patient's vitals, dispensing medicines, and so on

- Improvements in efficiency, productivity, quality, and consistency, along with better resource utilisation, predictive maintenance, greater safety, and minimal downtime, lead to savings across the enterprise
- Inherent flexibility and scalability enable the business to react quickly to market changes

What are the challenges

- The initial investment is high
- Integrating polyfunctional robots into existing workflows could be difficult in some companies due to a lack of skills, safety regulations, and so on
- There are also some ethical considerations surrounding job displacement and data privacy

What does the future look like

- Almost all established robotics firms have begun producing polyfunctional robots, including Boston Dynamics, ABB, Fanuc, and Universal Robots. And there are startups like Rainbow Robotics, Agibot, Hetbot, Aro Robotic Systems, Workr Labs, Aeon Robotics, and FingerVision
- Startups in India like CynLr, Sakar Robotics, Invento Robotics (Mitra), Gridbots, and Muks Robotics are also working in this space, either making polyfunctional robots or essential software and hardware components
- The unprecedented growth of AI and ML technologies is directly giving a boost to polyfunctional robots in terms of cost and capabilities
- As the cost of required hardware components is coming down, industry analysts feel the prices of polyfunctional robots are also

Industries utilising polyfunctional robots

- Manufacturing
- Healthcare
- Logistics and warehousing
- Agriculture
- Construction
- Aerospace
- Food processing
- Mining
- Defence
- Space exploration

bound to go down in the future

- According to the *Global Polyfunctional Robots Market Study* by HTF Market Intelligence Pvt Ltd, the market for polyfunctional robots is set to expand from US\$8 billion in 2025 to US\$45 billion by 2032 at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 12.5%
- Gartner predicts that by 2030, 80% of humans will engage with smart robots daily, up from less than 10% today **EFY**

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